

OBSERVER PATTERN

Behavioural Design Pattern

Problem Statement

Imagine you have a weather station that measures temperature. There are multiple devices like **phones, TVs, and displays** that need to show this temperature.

Without Observer Pattern

The weather station would need to know about every single device and manually update each one when the temperature changes.

This creates a big problem:

- Weather station is **tightly connected** to all devices
- Adding a new device means **changing weather station code**
- Removing a device means **changing weather station code** again
- Weather station **depends** on specific device types

Observer Pattern Benefits

Loose Coupling: The main object (like `WeatherStation`) **doesn't need to know** anything about the specific devices. It just sends notifications to whoever is listening, without caring what type of device it is.

Easy to Scale: You can add as many new devices as you want (phones, TVs, smartwatches, etc.) without changing a single line of code in the `WeatherStation`. Just register the new device and it starts receiving updates automatically.

Flexible at Runtime: Devices can join or leave the notification list anytime while the program is running. A device can start listening when it needs updates and stop listening when it doesn't.

Observer Pattern Use Cases

Event Listeners in Apps: When you build apps with buttons and forms, the Observer Pattern helps handle user actions. For example, when someone clicks a button or types in a text box, all the listeners get notified automatically and can react accordingly.

Stock Price Tracking: Imagine you're tracking Reliance or TCS stock prices. When the price changes, all investors and trading systems that are watching that stock get instant notifications about the new price. They don't need to keep checking manually.

News Apps and Blogs: When a news website publishes a new article, all users who have subscribed to that website automatically receive notifications. Like how you get alerts when your favorite blog posts something new.

Social Media Updates: Think of Instagram or Twitter. When someone you follow posts a new photo or tweet, you get a notification. You're an observer, and the account you follow is the subject. When they post (subject changes), all followers (observers) are notified.